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How to Build a Metaverse for Foodies

In conversation with co-founder of world's first food metaverse on how food and beverage industry will adapt to Web3 and beyond



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In 2021, OneRare was only a food metaverse game, founded by husband-wife duo Supreet Raju and Gaurav Gupta, which ran on NFTs and blockchain. A year and a funding of two million dollars later, the Web 3 startup is working to add another layer to the mix, the hyper-real virtual restaurants. Many leading chefs, including Saransh Goila and Vicky Ratnani, have partnered with the company to secure themselves a place in the world's first food metaverse. We met OneRare's co-founder Supreet Raju in a coffee shop in South Delhi and asked why she is striving to build a metaverse for chefs, restaurants and foodies. Edited interview excerpts follow:

Let's address the elephant in the room. Are you building your metaverse for a future where humans will eat virtually?

Supreet Raju: No, not at all. That is dystopian. Somebody in Japan came up with a technology where you can lick a board and get the taste of food, and frankly I don't want anything to do with it. For me, the experience of food lies in

the real world. To put it very simply, the foodverse we are building is a round cycle. Somebody goes and plays our game and they get rewarded for it with an NFT. That reward can come to the real world because you – the end user, the foodie – can swap the NFT you earned in our game or elsewhere for a meal at a restaurant, and for us, that is a cycle.

What we are doing is that we are taking a very real industry like food into a technology inside Web 3. So if you go to social media and you are following a popular chef, it is because their content is fun. The content format will itself move from 2D to 3D in a decade. So that is what we want to be. We want to be the immersive Instagram for the food and beverage industry. We're building the world's first food metaverse, which basically allows the global food industry to come into Web 3, use blockchain technology to monetize and market their business better.

How will a Web 3 game help in the business of chefs and restaurants though?

Supreet Raju: The most engaged user with the blockchain right now is the

Supreet Raju, Co-founder, OneRare

gamer. Blockchain as a technology is very complicated. The way it is presented is even more complicated. So for somebody like me from a design background, when I would read about blockchain earlier, it made me feel stupid. Blockchain is designed in a way that it's so tech heavy that people don't really get it. So that's why games have started doing well, not just ours, but others, because they simplify the technology and they make it more engaging for the user.

To be very honest, we started as a gaming project. So when the idea first came to us in January 2021, the NFT market was booming. My cofounder Gaurav Gupta, also my husband, has been in the blockchain industry since 2017, so he was well aware of this space. I had worked on a few projects as well. So when we saw NFTs, we wanted to make a creative project around it. We chose the topic of food because it is something that everybody knows. You'll have a favorite dish. You'll have a dish you'd never eat. Everybody has this natural love for food. So we